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Nikola Tesla, Asimov, Stephen Hawking and several others have predicted a fundamental restructuring of society in a post-robotic world.

control. At some level, it appears like this would have to be some human error - surely, if we're careful enough about something so important, it's impossible to 'write a bug' that will allow robots to misinterpret human instructions and wreak havoc? Asimov's three rules for a robot, from his short story 'Runaround' (1942) stand solemnly as guide -

1. A robot may not injure a human being or, through inaction, allow a human being to come to harm.
2. A robot must obey orders given it by human beings except where such orders would conflict with the First Law.
3. A robot must protect its own existence as long as such protection does not conflict with the First or Second Law.

The devil, of course, is in the details. It is conceivable that a small oversight somewhere could precipitate into something disastrous (for humans), especially if and when robots develop an intelligence to compete with that of humans. As charted, robots are rapidly developing superior processing abilities than human beings in several small functions - face recognition, path prediction, puzzle solving, chess and Go, just to name a few.

However, what remains to be done is to integrate these functions together into a truly comprehensive 'intelligence'. It is in such a case that serious philosophical questions of ethics, morality and agency will come into play.

Until then, we can still comfortably hook Arduinos up to our toasters so that we can bathe while getting breakfast ready.